UNIT I

UNDERSTANDING GENDER

1. INTRODUCTION TO GENDER

1.1 What is Gender?

Gender refers to the socially and culturally constructed roles, behaviours, expectations, rights, and responsibilities assigned to individuals based on their perceived sex. Unlike biological differences, gender roles are created by society and vary across cultures and time periods.

Every society develops norms about how men and women should behave. These norms influence education, employment, family responsibilities, leadership opportunities, and social interactions.

For example:

- Boys are often encouraged to play outdoor games, whereas girls are encouraged to play indoor games.
- Men are traditionally viewed as breadwinners, while women are expected to manage household responsibilities.

These expectations are products of society rather than biology.

1.2 Why Study Gender?

Understanding gender helps us to:

- Promote equality and justice.
- Eliminate discrimination.
- Create inclusive workplaces.
- Respect diversity.
- Improve social development.
- Build healthier personal and professional relationships.

For engineering students, gender awareness is essential because engineers work in diverse teams and design products and infrastructure that serve all members of society.

2. DEFINITION OF GENDER

According to the **World Health Organization (WHO):**

"Gender refers to the socially constructed characteristics of women and men, including norms, roles, relationships, behaviours, and opportunities associated with being female or male."

Gender is learned through family, education, religion, media, and society.

3. BASIC GENDER CONCEPTS AND TERMINOLOGY

To understand gender sensitization, it is essential to become familiar with the basic concepts and terminology used in gender studies.Gender is a multidimensional concept that influences every aspect of human life, including education, employment, health, politics, family relationships, and social interactions.

Many people confuse terms such as sex, gender, gender identity, gender equality, and gender equity. Each term has a distinct meaning and helps us understand how societies create and maintain gender roles and how these can be transformed to promote equality and inclusion.

3.1 Gender

Gender refers to the socially and culturally constructed roles, behaviors, expectations, responsibilities, and opportunities associated with being a woman, a man, or another gender identity.

3.1.1 Characteristics of Gender

- Socially constructed.
- Learned through family, school, religion, media, and culture.
- Changes over time and across societies.
- Influences opportunities and responsibilities.
- Can be challenged and redefined.

Examples

- Boys are expected to be brave.
- Girls are expected to be caring.
- Men are expected to earn income.
- Women are expected to manage household work.

These are social expectations, not biological necessities.

3.2 Sex

Sex refers to the biological and physiological characteristics that distinguish males and females. It is determined at birth based on physical characteristics such as reproductive organs, chromosomes, and hormones.

According to the World Health Organization (WHO):

Sex refers to the different biological and physiological characteristics of males and females, such as reproductive organs, chromosomes, hormones, and secondary sexual characteristics.

3.2.1 Characteristics of Sex

- Biological in nature.
- Determined before birth through genetic inheritance.

- Based on chromosomes (XX for most females and XY for most males, with natural biological variations also occurring).
- Associated with reproductive organs and hormones.
- Generally consistent across cultures.
- Influences reproductive functions.

3.3 Comparison between sex and gender

Basis	Sex	Gender
Meaning	Biological differences between males and females.	Social and cultural roles, behaviours, and expectations.
Nature	Biological.	Social and cultural.
Determination	At birth.	Learned throughout life
Basis	Chromosomes, hormones, and reproductive organs.	Society, culture, traditions, and upbringing.
Changeability	Usually remains constant throughout life, although some biological characteristics can change through medical interventions.	Can change across cultures and over time.
Universality	Similar across all societies.	Differs from one society to another.
Examples	Pregnancy, menstruation, sperm production.	Cooking, leadership, childcare, career expectations.

3.4. Gender Identity

Gender identity refers to an individual's deeply felt internal sense of who they are in terms of gender. It is a personal and internal experience that may or may not correspond to the sex assigned at birth.

A person may identify as:

- Male: A person identifies as a man
- Female: A person identifies as a woman
- Non-binary: person does not identify exclusively as male or female
- Gender Fluid: A person's gender identity may change or vary over time.

Gender identity is personal and may not always align with the sex assigned at birth.

3.4.1 Gender Identity vs Gender Expression

These two concepts are often confused.

Example

A woman may prefer short hair and traditionally masculine clothing. Her appearance (gender expression) does not determine her gender identity.

Gender Identity	Gender Expression
Internal sense of gender	External presentation of gender
How a person feels inside	How a person expresses themselves
Personal understanding	Clothing, hairstyle, behaviour, voice, mannerisms

3.5 Gender Equality

Gender equality refers to the equal rights, responsibilities, and opportunities of women, men, girls, and boys. It means that the interests, needs, and priorities of all genders are taken into consideration.

It includes equality in:

- Education
- Employment opportunities
- pay for equal work
- Participation in leadership and decision-making
- Access to healthcare
- Legal rights and protection.
- Freedom from discrimination and violence.
- opportunities to develop skills and talents.

3.6 Gender Equity

Gender equity is the process of being fair to women, men, girls, and boys by recognizing their different needs and circumstances and providing appropriate resources and opportunities to achieve equal outcomes.

Therefore, fairness may require:

- Different levels of support.
- Different policies.
- Special protections.
- Additional opportunities.

The ultimate goal is to enable everyone to participate on equal terms.

Example:
Providing maternity leave and paternity leave supports both parents in balancing work and family responsibilities.

3.7 Gender Discrimination

Gender discrimination refers to the unfair or unequal treatment of an individual based on their gender rather than their abilities, qualifications, or performance. It occurs when people are denied opportunities, rights, or resources because they are male, female, or belong to another gender identity.

Examples include:

- Unequal pay
- Preference for sons
- Limited educational opportunities for girls
- Workplace harassment
- Unequal promotions

3.8 Gender Stereotypes

Gender stereotypes are widely accepted but oversimplified beliefs or assumptions about the characteristics, roles, behaviours, and abilities of people based solely on their gender.

Gender stereotypes are ideas such as:

- Men are naturally better leaders.
- Women are naturally better caregivers.
- Boys are better at mathematics.
- Girls are better at cooking.
- Men should not express emotions.
- Women should stay at home.

These beliefs are learned through society and culture and are not universal truths.

3.9 Patriarchy

Patriarchy is a social system in which men hold primary power and authority in the family, society, economy, religion, and politics. In a patriarchal society, men are generally regarded as the heads of families and decision-makers, while women often have less access to power, resources, and opportunities. The term patriarchy comes from the Greek words where Patria means Father and Arche means Rule or authority.

Characteristics:

- Male dominance.

- Male inheritance.
- Male leadership.
- Control over family decisions.

Effects:

- Gender inequality.
- Limited opportunities for women.
- Economic dependence.

3.10 Feminism

Feminism is one of the most significant social movements in the world. It advocates equal rights, equal opportunities, and equal treatment for women in all aspects of life. It is important to understand that feminism is not about women being superior to men. Rather, it is about creating a society where all people, regardless of gender, can live with dignity, freedom, and equal opportunities.

3.11 Masculinity

Masculinity refers to the qualities, behaviours, roles, and expectations that society traditionally associates with men and boys. These characteristics are not fixed by biology; they are largely shaped by culture, family, education, religion, media, and socialization.

Examples:

- Strength.
- Courage.
- Independence.
- Leadership.

Healthy masculinity encourages responsibility and respect without promoting dominance.

3.12 Femininity

Femininity refers to the qualities, behaviours, attitudes, and roles that society traditionally associates with women and girls. Like masculinity, femininity is not determined by biology; it is largely shaped by culture, traditions, family, education, religion, media, and socialization.

Examples:

- Compassion.
- Nurturing.
- Kindness.
- Empathy.

- Cooperation.
- Patience.
- Emotional expression.

Modern perspectives recognize that these qualities are not limited to one gender.

3.13 Empowerment

Empowerment is the process of increasing an individual's or group's ability to make informed decisions, exercise control over their lives, and participate fully in society.

Empowerment means giving individuals:

- Knowledge to understand their rights and opportunities.
- Skills to improve their abilities and livelihoods.
- Confidence to express their opinions and make decisions.
- Resources such as education, finance, healthcare, and technology.
- Opportunities to participate equally in family, workplace, and society.

Empowerment is not about giving one group power over another. It is about creating conditions where everyone has the ability and freedom to make choices and achieve their goals.

4. EXPLORING ATTITUDES TOWARDS GENDER

Attitudes towards gender refer to the beliefs, opinions, perceptions, and feelings that individuals and society have about the roles, responsibilities, abilities, and rights of people based on their gender. These attitudes influence how people behave toward others and shape expectations regarding education, employment, leadership, family life, and social participation.

Gender attitudes are not innate; they are **learned through socialization** and are influenced by family, education, culture, religion, media, peers, and personal experiences. Positive gender attitudes promote equality, mutual respect, and inclusion, whereas negative attitudes can reinforce stereotypes, discrimination, and inequality.

Exploring attitudes towards gender helps us identify biases, challenge stereotypes, and develop a more inclusive and equitable society.

Gender attitudes refer to beliefs and opinions about:

- The roles of men and women.
- Rights and responsibilities.
- Leadership abilities.
- Career choices.
- Household responsibilities.
- Education.
- Decision-making.
- Social participation.

4.1 Factors influencing Gender Attitudes

Gender attitudes are formed through the process of gender socialization.

a. Family

The family is the first place where children learn gender attitudes.

Examples:

- Encouraging boys to play outdoor sports while girls play with dolls.
- Assigning household chores mainly to girls.
- Expecting boys to be brave and independent.
- Children often imitate the attitudes and behaviours of parents and other family members.

b. School

Schools influence gender attitudes through:

- Teachers' expectations.
- Textbooks and learning materials.
- Sports participation.
- Classroom interactions.
- Student leadership opportunities.

Teachers who encourage equal participation help develop positive gender attitudes.

c. Media

Television, films, newspapers, advertisements, and social media strongly influence gender attitudes.

Traditional portrayals may show:

- Men as leaders and decision-makers.
- Women as homemakers and caregivers.

Modern media increasingly presents:

- Women as scientists, engineers, entrepreneurs, and political leaders.
- Men as caring fathers, teachers, and nurses.

Positive representation helps challenge stereotypes.

d. Culture and Traditions

Customs and traditions influence attitudes about:

- Marriage.
- Family responsibilities.
- Occupations.
- Leadership.
- Education.

These attitudes vary across cultures and evolve over time.

e. Religion

Religious teachings and cultural interpretations may influence expectations regarding gender roles, family responsibilities, and leadership. Different faiths and communities interpret these issues in diverse ways.

f. Peer Groups

Friends and classmate's influence:

- Career aspirations.
- Clothing preferences.
- Behavior.
- Language.
- Interests.

Peer acceptance or pressure can shape gender attitudes during adolescence.

4.2 Types of Gender Attitudes

Broadly, gender attitudes can be classified into three types:

i. Traditional Gender Attitudes
ii. Egalitarian (Gender-Equal) Attitudes
iii. Transformative Gender Attitudes

4.2.1 Traditional Attitudes

Traditional gender attitudes are beliefs that support conventional or historically accepted roles for men and women. These attitudes assume that men and women have different responsibilities based primarily on gender.

Characteristics:

- Support traditional gender roles.
- Men are considered primary decision-makers.
- Women are expected to manage household responsibilities.
- Leadership is often viewed as a male role.
- Household work is mainly assigned to women.
- Men are expected to be financial providers.
- Career choices may be influenced by gender stereotypes.

Examples:

- Men should earn income while women should care for the home.
- Engineering is mainly suitable for men.

- Nursing and teaching young children are mainly suitable for women.
- Fathers should make important family decisions.
- Women should prioritize marriage over careers.
- Boys should not cry because it shows weakness.

Limitations:

- Gender inequality.
- Unequal educational opportunities.
- Wage inequality.
- Limited career choices.
- Reduced participation of women in leadership.
- Pressure on men to always be financial providers.
- Reinforcement of stereotypes.

4.2.2 Egalitarian (Gender-Equal) Attitudes

Egalitarian attitudes believe that all genders should enjoy equal rights, responsibilities, opportunities, and respect. Opportunities should be based on ability, qualifications, and interest but not on gender.

Characteristics:

- Equal education.
- Equal employment opportunities.
- Equal pay for equal work.
- Shared household responsibilities.
- Equal participation in leadership.
- Equal respect and dignity.
- Equal legal protection.

Examples:

- Men and women should share household work.
- Leadership depends on ability rather than gender.
- Girls and boys should receive equal educational opportunities.
- Fathers and mothers should participate equally in childcare.
- Engineering is suitable for anyone with the required skills and interest.

4.2.3 Transformative Gender Attitudes

Transformative gender attitudes go beyond supporting equality. They actively seek to challenge and change harmful gender norms, stereotypes, and unequal power relationships.

These attitudes encourage individuals and institutions to question traditional assumptions and create environments where everyone can participate equally.

Characteristics:

- Challenge gender stereotypes.

- Encourage shared decision-making.
- Promote equal leadership opportunities.
- Address discrimination and bias.
- Support inclusive policies.
- Encourage respect for diversity.
- Promote positive masculinity and femininity.

Examples:

- Encouraging boys to participate in caregiving and household work.
- Encouraging girls to pursue engineering, science, or leadership roles.
- Promoting equal parental leave policies.
- Challenging workplace bias in recruitment and promotions.
- Creating gender-sensitive educational programs.

4.3 Importance of Positive Gender Attitudes

- Positive gender attitudes promote equality, fairness, dignity, respect, and inclusion.
- They help reduce discrimination and gender stereotypes.
- Positive attitudes improve education, employment, leadership, family relationships, and workplace culture.
- They encourage shared responsibilities, equal opportunities, and mutual respect.
- Positive gender attitudes contribute to economic development, social harmony, innovation, and sustainable development.
- Engineering students and professionals should practice merit-based evaluation, teamwork, inclusive behaviour, and respect for diversity to build equitable and productive workplaces.

5. CONSTRUCTION OF GENDER

Construction of gender is the social and cultural process through which society creates, teaches, and reinforces gender roles, behaviours, expectations, and identities for individuals. Rigid gender construction can contribute to stereotypes, discrimination, unequal opportunities, and occupational segregation.

5.1 Agents of Gender Construction

5.1.1 Family

The family is the first and most influential agent of gender construction. Children begin learning gender roles from birth.

Examples

Boys are often given toy cars, robots, and sports equipment.
Girls are often given dolls, kitchen sets, or soft toys.
Boys may be encouraged to be brave and independent.
Girls may be encouraged to be caring and polite.
Household chores may be divided based on gender.

5.1.2 School

Schools are the second most important agent of gender construction. They shape children's attitudes through education, teachers, textbooks, extracurricular activities, and peer interactions.

Teachers influence students by:

- Encouraging equal participation.
- Avoiding gender bias.
- Treating boys and girls fairly.

Schools should promote gender-sensitive education, encourage equal leadership opportunities, prevent bullying and discrimination and conduct gender awareness programs.

5.1.3 Peer Groups

Peer groups include friends, classmates, neighbours, and colleagues. During adolescence, peers strongly influence attitudes, behaviour, interests, and identity.

Example

A boy interested in dance or a girl interested in mechanical engineering may face peer pressure if these interests are viewed as "non-traditional."

5.1.4 Media

The media is a powerful agent of gender construction because it shapes public perceptions through television, films, newspapers, advertisements, the internet, and social media. Media influences how people view the roles and abilities of men and women by presenting different images and stories. Traditional media often portrayed men as leaders and women as homemakers, whereas modern media increasingly highlights women as engineers, scientists, entrepreneurs, and political leaders, and men as caring fathers and teachers. Positive media representation helps reduce stereotypes and promotes gender equality.

5.1.5 Culture and Traditions

Culture includes the beliefs, customs, values, language, and traditions passed from one generation to another.
Cultural practices often determine responsibilities related to family, education, occupations, leadership, and marriage. Since cultures differ across societies and change over time, gender roles also vary. Modern societies are gradually adopting cultural values that encourage equal opportunities and shared responsibilities for all genders.

5.1.6 Religion

Religion influences gender construction by shaping moral values, ethical principles, and social behavior. Religious teachings and cultural interpretations may influence attitudes toward family roles, marriage, leadership, and responsibilities. Many religious traditions also promote values such as respect, compassion, justice, and human dignity, which can support gender equality when interpreted in an inclusive manner.

5.1.7 Workplace

The workplace is an important agent of gender construction because it influences attitudes through organizational culture.

- Recruitment practices.
- Promotions.
- Leadership opportunities.
- Workplace culture.
- Policies on parental leave and flexible work.

5.1.8 Government and Laws

Governments shape gender construction by:

- Promoting equal education.
- Enacting anti-discrimination laws.
- Protecting against workplace harassment.
- Supporting equal employment opportunities.
- Encouraging women's participation in leadership.

Legal reforms can help transform social attitudes toward gender.

5.1.9 Importance of Understanding Gender Construction

Understanding gender construction helps in

- Distinguish between biological differences and social expectations.
- Recognize and challenge stereotypes.
- Promote gender equality.
- Respect individual choices.
- Support equal opportunities.
- Create inclusive educational institutions and workplaces.

6. SOCIALIZATION: MAKING WOMEN, MAKING MEN

Socialization is the lifelong process through which individuals learn the values, beliefs, customs, attitudes, behaviours, and social norms of their society. It helps people understand how to behave appropriately in different social situations and prepares them to become responsible members of society.

One of the most important aspects of socialization is gender socialization, through which children learn what society expects from them as boys or girls. From birth, children are taught specific roles, behaviours, and responsibilities based on their gender. These lessons come from family, schools, peers, media, religion, culture, and society.

The expression "Making Women, Making Men" refers to the process by which society shapes the personalities, interests, responsibilities, and expectations of individuals according to gender.

Children are not born knowing how boys or girls should behave. Instead, they gradually learn these expectations through interaction with family members, teachers, friends, media, religion, and society.

For example:

Boys may be encouraged to be independent, courageous, and competitive.

Girls may be encouraged to be caring, patient, and cooperative.

6.1 Agents of Socialization

Family

The family is the primary agent of socialization.

Children learn gender roles by observing parents and relatives.

Examples:

- Girls helping with cooking.
- Boys helping with outdoor work.
- Different expectations for behavior.

School

Schools reinforce or challenge gender roles through:

- Teachers.
- Textbooks.
- Classroom participation.
- Sports.
- Leadership opportunities.

Peer Groups

Friends influence:

- Clothing
- Language
- Behaviour
- Career aspirations

Mass Media

Television, films, advertisements, and social media influence perceptions about masculinity and femininity.

6.2 Making Men

The process of **making men** begins in childhood when boys are taught qualities that society traditionally associates with masculinity. Boys are often encouraged to be brave, confident, independent, physically strong, competitive, and responsible. Parents may expect boys to become future providers and decision-makers for their families. Boys often learn these expectations by observing fathers and other male role models.

Schools influence boys by encouraging leadership, teamwork, discipline, sports participation, problem-solving, and technical skills. While traditional education often emphasized leadership and competition, modern educational practices also encourage boys to develop communication skills, empathy, cooperation, and respect for others.

The media traditionally portrayed men as leaders, engineers, soldiers, business executives, and protectors. Today, media also presents men as caring fathers, teachers, nurses, caregivers, and supportive partners, helping to broaden society's understanding of masculinity.

Culture and traditions have historically expected men to earn income, protect the family, make important decisions, and lead the household. Although these expectations continue in some societies, modern perspectives emphasize that responsibilities such as childcare, household work, and family decision-making should be shared equally between men and women.

Modern society encourages men to express their emotions openly, participate actively in childcare and household responsibilities, respect women, support gender equality, and build healthy relationships. Healthy masculinity focuses on responsibility, empathy, emotional intelligence, cooperation, and respect rather than dominance or control over others.

6.3 Making Women

The process of making women begins in **early childhood** when girls are taught the qualities and responsibilities that society traditionally associates with femininity. Parents often encourage girls to be gentle, caring, patient, polite, and emotionally expressive. Girls are frequently expected to help with household chores such as cooking, cleaning, and caring for younger siblings. Through observation and imitation of mothers and other female family members, girls learn traditional family roles and responsibilities.

Schools also contribute to making women by shaping girls' attitudes, confidence, and aspirations. Teachers, textbooks, and classroom activities influence how girls perceive themselves and their future roles in society. Modern education encourages girls to participate equally in academics, sports, science, engineering, leadership, and other fields, helping them overcome traditional gender stereotypes.

The media has a significant influence on making women by portraying different images of women. Earlier, women were mainly shown as homemakers and caregivers, but today they are increasingly represented as engineers, scientists, entrepreneurs, doctors, police officers, and political leaders. These positive representations encourage girls to pursue higher education and diverse careers.

Culture and traditions also influence the process of making women by defining expectations regarding marriage, family responsibilities, dress, behaviour, and occupations. However, these

expectations differ across societies and have evolved over time. Modern society increasingly promotes equal opportunities, financial independence, leadership, and decision-making for women.

Today, women are encouraged to become educated, financially independent, confident, and capable of contributing equally in all fields, including engineering, medicine, business, politics, research, and public administration. Modern society recognizes that women's abilities should not be limited by traditional gender roles.

6.4 Comparison of making men and women

Aspect	Making Women (Traditional)	Making Men (Traditional)
Family role	Caregiver and homemaker	Provider and protector
Household work	Mainly responsible	Limited involvement
Emotional expression	Encouraged	Often discouraged
Leadership	Less encouraged	Strongly encouraged
Career	Family-oriented	Profession-oriented
Decision-making	Limited participation	Primary decision-maker

6.5 Importance of positive gender socialization

Positive gender socialization helps to:

- Promote gender equality.
- Reduce discrimination.
- Encourage equal educational opportunities.
- Support shared family responsibilities.
- Improve workplace inclusion.
- Develop confident and responsible individuals.
- Foster mutual respect and healthy relationships.

7. PREPARING FOR WOMANHOOD

Preparing for womanhood is the lifelong process through which girls acquire the knowledge, values, skills, attitudes, and confidence required to become responsible adults. This preparation begins in childhood and continues through adolescence into adulthood. It helps girls understand the physical and emotional changes associated with puberty, develop self-esteem, make informed decisions, and participate actively in education, employment, and community life.

7.1 Physical preparation

- Girls experience physical changes during puberty, such as growth in height and weight.
- Development of secondary sexual characteristics occurs during adolescence.
- Menstruation begins, requiring knowledge of menstrual hygiene and reproductive health.

- Proper nutrition, regular exercise, and personal hygiene are essential for healthy development.
- Regular health check-ups help maintain physical well-being.

7.2 Emotional and Psychological Changes

- Girls experience emotional and psychological changes during adolescence.
- They should develop self-confidence and self-esteem.
- Emotional intelligence helps them understand and manage emotions.
- Decision-making and problem-solving skills should be encouraged.
- Parents and teachers should provide emotional support and guidance.

7.3 Social Preparation

- Girls learn social values such as respect, honesty, kindness, and cooperation.
- They develop communication and interpersonal skills.
- Participation in family and community activities improves social responsibility.
- Girls should be encouraged to respect diversity and promote gender equality.
- Teamwork and leadership qualities should be developed.

7.4 Preparing for Womanhood in Modern Society

- Modern society encourages girls to become educated and financially independent.
- Women are encouraged to participate in science, engineering, business, politics, sports, and research.
- Equal participation in leadership and decision-making is promoted.
- Women are encouraged to balance personal and professional responsibilities according to their choices.
- Modern preparation focuses on equal rights, dignity, and self-reliance.

7.5 Importance of Preparing for Womanhood

- Builds self-confidence and self-esteem.
- Promotes education and lifelong learning.
- Encourages financial independence.
- Improves health and well-being.
- Develops leadership and communication skills.
- Promotes gender equality and women's empowerment.
- Helps women contribute to family, society, and national development.

8. GROWING UP MALE

Growing up male refers to the process through which boys develop into adult men through physical, emotional, psychological, social, and moral development. It is influenced by family, school, peer groups, media, culture, religion, and society. During this process, boys learn the roles, responsibilities, attitudes, and behaviours that society traditionally associates with masculinity. While biological changes occur naturally during adolescence, many expectations about how boys should behave are learned through gender socialization. Modern society encourages boys to develop into responsible, respectful, emotionally healthy, and gender-sensitive individuals.

8.1 Physical Development

- Boys experience puberty during adolescence.
- They undergo rapid growth in height and weight.
- Their muscles become stronger, and shoulders broaden.
- Facial and body hair begin to develop.
- The voice becomes deeper.
- Reproductive organs mature.
- Proper nutrition, regular exercise, personal hygiene, and healthcare are essential for healthy physical development.

8.2 Emotional and Psychological Development

- Boys experience emotional and psychological changes during adolescence.
- They begin developing self-confidence and self-identity.
- They may experience stress, anxiety, or confusion while adjusting to physical and emotional changes.
- Society often expects boys to suppress emotions and avoid showing vulnerability.
- Modern perspectives encourage boys to express emotions in healthy ways and seek help when needed.
- Developing emotional intelligence helps boys build healthy relationships and make responsible decisions.

8.3 Social Development

- Boys learn social values such as honesty, respect, responsibility, cooperation, and discipline.
- They develop communication and interpersonal skills through interactions with family, friends, and teachers.
- Participation in sports, cultural activities, and teamwork improves social confidence.
- Boys learn to respect diversity and appreciate gender equality.
- Social development helps them become responsible members of society.

8.4 Healthy Masculinity

Healthy masculinity encourages boys to:

- Respect women and all individuals.
- Express emotions appropriately.
- Show empathy and compassion.
- Share family responsibilities.
- Reject violence and discrimination.
- Build healthy relationships.
- Support gender equality.
- Develop confidence without dominating others.

8.5 Challenges Faced by Boys During Adolescence

- Physical and emotional changes during puberty.
- Pressure to meet societal expectations of masculinity.
- Academic and career stress.
- Peer pressure.
- Mental health concerns.
- Difficulty expressing emotions due to social expectations.
- Balancing independence with family responsibilities.

8.6 Growing Up Male in Modern Society

- Modern society encourages boys to become educated, responsible, and emotionally intelligent individuals.
- Boys are encouraged to share household work and childcare responsibilities.
- Equal respect for all genders is promoted.
- Career choices should depend on ability and interest rather than stereotypes.
- Boys are encouraged to become supportive family members, ethical professionals, and responsible citizens.

9. FIRST LESSONS IN CASTE

- Caste is a traditional system of social stratification in India in which people are grouped into different social categories, usually determined by birth.
- It has historically influenced a person's occupation, social status, marriage, and interactions with others.
- Although the Indian Constitution guarantees equality and prohibits caste-based discrimination, caste continues to influence social life in many communities.
- Children are not born with ideas about caste; they learn them gradually from the people and institutions around them.

9.1 How Children Learn About Caste

Children learn about caste through various agents of socialization.

9.1.1 Family

- The family is the first place where children are introduced to caste identity.
- Parents and grandparents may tell children about their caste, community traditions, and customs.
- Children observe the behaviour of elders toward people belonging to different castes.
- They may learn whom they should marry, celebrate festivals with, or interact with based on family beliefs.
- Families that promote equality teach children to respect all people irrespective of caste.

9.1.2 School

- Schools bring together children from different caste backgrounds.
- Students learn values such as equality, cooperation, and mutual respect through classroom interactions.
- Teachers play an important role in preventing discrimination and promoting inclusive education.
- Textbooks that emphasize constitutional values help students understand the importance of social equality.
- Equal participation in classroom activities reduces caste-based prejudice.

9.1.3 Peer Groups

- Friends influence children's understanding of caste through daily interactions.
- Positive friendships across different communities help reduce prejudice and stereotypes.
- Negative peer influence may reinforce discriminatory attitudes if children imitate biased behaviour.

9.1.4 Community and Society

- Community customs, festivals, religious practices, and local traditions influence children's understanding of caste.
- In some communities, children may observe separate social practices based on caste.
- Community leaders and social organizations can promote harmony by encouraging equality and inclusion.

9.1.5 Media

- Television, newspapers, films, books, and social media influence children's understanding of caste.
- Positive media promotes equality, diversity, and social justice.
- Educational programs and documentaries help children understand the harmful effects of discrimination.

9.2 Effects of Early Caste Socialization

9.2.1 Positive Effects (When Equality is Taught)

- Respect for all individuals.
- Appreciation of cultural diversity.
- Development of inclusive attitudes.
- Better social relationships.
- Promotion of constitutional values.
- Social harmony and cooperation.

9.2.2 Negative Effects (When Discrimination is Taught)

- Development of prejudice.
- Social exclusion.

- Discrimination against certain groups.
- Bullying and unfair treatment.
- Reduced self-confidence among affected children.
- Division within society.
- Violation of human rights and equality.

9.3 Relationship between Gender and Caste

Gender, caste, and intersectionality are interconnected concepts which helps to understand how different social identities influence a person's life experiences, opportunities, and challenges. While gender shapes the roles and expectations of men and women, caste influences social status and access to resources in some communities. Intersectionality explains how these identities overlap, creating unique experiences of privilege or discrimination. Understanding this relationship is essential for promoting equality, inclusion, and social justice.

Gender and caste are two important social systems that influence an individual's identity and position in society. Although they are different concepts, they often interact in everyday life.

Both are Socially Constructed

- Gender roles are created by society and culture, while caste is a social system based on birth.
- Both influence how people are treated and what society expects from them.
- These expectations vary across different cultures and communities.

Both Influence Opportunities

- Gender and caste together can affect access to education, healthcare, employment, and leadership positions.
- Women from socially disadvantaged caste groups may face more barriers than women from socially advantaged groups because of the combined effects of gender and caste.

Both Affect Social Status

- Gender influences expectations regarding family roles, careers, and responsibilities.
- Caste influences social identity, community relationships, and historical access to resources.
- Together, they shape an individual's social position.

Both Can Lead to Discrimination

- A person may face discrimination because of gender, caste, or both.
- For example, a girl from a marginalized caste may experience unequal treatment in education or employment due to the combined influence of gender and caste.

9.3.1 What is Intersectionality?

Intersectionality is the concept that different social identities, such as gender, caste, class, religion, disability, age, and ethnicity, overlap and interact to shape a person's experiences.

The term was introduced by Kimberlé Crenshaw in 1989 to explain that discrimination is often caused by multiple factors rather than a single identity.

Intersectionality helps us understand that people do not experience society based on only one identity. Instead, their experiences are influenced by the combination of all their identities.

9.3.2 Importance of Understanding the Relationship

Understanding the relationship between gender, caste, and intersectionality helps to:

- Promote gender equality.
- Eliminate caste-based discrimination.
- Recognize the needs of marginalized groups.
- Develop inclusive educational and workplace policies.
- Ensure equal opportunities for everyone.
- Strengthen social justice and human rights.
- Promote respect for diversity.
- Build an inclusive and harmonious society.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITIES

1. **Group Discussion:** *"Are gender roles changing in modern India? Discuss with examples."*
2. **Role Play:** Demonstrate how gender stereotypes influence career choices.
3. **Debate:** *"Gender equality benefits both men and women."*
4. **Reflection Exercise:** Students write a one-page reflection on how family, school, or media shaped their understanding of gender.

2-MARK QUESTIONS (SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS)

1. **Define gender.**

   Gender refers to the socially and culturally constructed roles, behaviors, responsibilities, and expectations associated with men, women, and other gender identities. Unlike sex, gender is shaped by society and can vary across cultures and time.

2. **Differentiate between sex and gender.**

Sex	Gender
Biological characteristics determined at birth.	Socially and culturally constructed roles and behaviors.
Based on physical and physiological differences.	Based on social expectations and norms.
Generally remains constant.	Can change across societies and cultures.

3. **What is gender identity?**

   Gender identity is an individual's personal and internal sense of being male, female, both, neither, or another gender. It may or may not correspond to the person's biological sex assigned at birth.

4. **Define gender roles.**

   Gender roles are the behaviors, responsibilities, and expectations that society considers appropriate for men and women. These roles are learned through socialization and differ across cultures.

5. **What is meant by gender equality?**

   Gender equality means providing equal rights, opportunities, responsibilities, and treatment to all individuals regardless of their gender. It ensures that everyone can participate equally in education, employment, and decision-making.

6. **Define gender equity.**

   Gender equity is the principle of providing fair treatment and equal opportunities by addressing the different needs and challenges faced by different genders to achieve gender equality.

7. What are gender stereotypes?

Gender stereotypes are generalized beliefs or assumptions about the characteristics, behaviors, or roles that men and women are expected to perform in society.

8. What is gender discrimination?

Gender discrimination is the unfair or unequal treatment of individuals based on their gender, resulting in unequal opportunities, rights, or privileges.

9. Define patriarchy.

Patriarchy is a social system in which men hold primary power and authority in family, social, economic, and political institutions, often leading to gender inequality.

10. What is feminism?

Feminism is a social and political movement that advocates equal rights, opportunities, and treatment for women in all aspects of life.

11. Define masculinity.

Masculinity refers to the qualities, behaviors, and roles that society traditionally associates with men, such as courage, responsibility, leadership, and confidence.

12. Define femininity.

Femininity refers to the qualities, behaviors, and characteristics traditionally associated with women, such as compassion, empathy, cooperation, and nurturing.

13. What is women's empowerment?

Women's empowerment is the process of enabling women to gain equal rights, education, economic independence, decision-making power, and freedom from discrimination and violence.

14. Mention any two characteristics of patriarchy.

- Male dominance in family and society.
- Men hold primary decision-making authority.

15. State any two objectives of gender equality.

- To provide equal opportunities in education and employment.
- To eliminate gender discrimination and promote equal rights.

16. List any four agents of gender socialization.

- Family
- School
- Peer groups
- Media

17. What is meant by gender socialization?

Gender socialization is the process through which society teaches individuals the roles, behaviours, attitudes, and responsibilities considered appropriate for their gender.

18. Define the social construction of gender.

The social construction of gender is the process through which society creates and assigns gender roles, behaviours, and expectations through social, cultural, and institutional influences.

19. Mention any two traditional gender stereotypes.

- Men are strong and should be family breadwinners.
- Women are caring and should manage household responsibilities.

20. How does family influence gender roles?

The family influences gender roles by teaching children behaviours, responsibilities, values, and expectations associated with their gender through observation, guidance, and daily interactions.

21. What role does school play in gender socialization?

Schools promote gender socialization by providing equal educational opportunities, encouraging gender-sensitive learning, eliminating stereotypes, and fostering mutual respect among students.

22. How does media influence gender attitudes?

Media influences gender attitudes by portraying images, roles, and behaviours of men and women, which can either reinforce stereotypes or promote gender equality.

23. Mention two challenges faced by girls during adolescence.

- Physical and emotional changes during puberty.
- Gender discrimination and unequal educational opportunities.

24. Mention two social expectations associated with growing up male.

- Boys are expected to be strong and independent.
- Boys are expected to become responsible decision-makers and financial providers.

25. What is meant by intersectionality?

Intersectionality is the concept that individuals may experience discrimination or privilege based on the combined effects of multiple social identities such as gender, caste, class, religion, disability, or ethnicity.

26. Mention any two rights that promote gender equality.

- Right to Equality (Articles 14 and 15 of the Indian Constitution).
- Right to Education (Article 21A of the Indian Constitution).

27. State two advantages of gender equality in society.

- Promotes equal opportunities and social justice.

- Enhances economic growth and national development by utilizing the talents of all individuals.

28. Explain the importance of studying gender sensitization for engineering students.

Gender sensitization helps engineering students develop respect for diversity, eliminate gender stereotypes, promote equal opportunities, and create inclusive, ethical, and professional workplaces. It also encourages teamwork, mutual respect, and compliance with workplace laws, contributing to a positive engineering environment.

ESSAY QUESTIONS

1. Define gender. Explain the difference between **sex and gender** with suitable examples.
2. Explain the **basic gender concepts and terminology** such as gender identity, gender roles, gender equality, gender equity, stereotypes, patriarchy, and feminism.
3. Discuss the importance of **gender sensitization** in higher education and the engineering profession.
4. Explain how attitudes towards gender are formed. Discuss the role of family, school, religion, media, and peer groups in shaping gender attitudes.
5. What is meant by the **social construction of gender**? Explain the various factors responsible for constructing gender roles in society.
6. Define **socialization**. Explain the process of gender socialization and discuss the role of various agents in making women and making men.
7. Explain the physical, emotional, psychological, and social changes associated with **preparing for womanhood**.
8. Discuss the social expectations associated with **growing up male** and explain their impact on personality development.
9. Explain how children learn about **caste** during socialization.
10. Discuss the relationship between **gender and caste** with suitable examples.
11. "Gender equality is essential for national development." Discuss with suitable examples.